

Stative Verbs

CEFR B1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

Stative verbs describe states, not actions, so they usually aren't used in continuous tenses. They cover:

- 1 Feelings and opinions — like, love, hate, want, prefer, believe.
- 2 Thoughts and senses — know, understand, remember, see, seem.
- 3 Possession and being — have, own, belong, be.

Say 'I want a coffee', not 'I'm wanting'. Some verbs (have, think, see) are stative in one meaning and active in another.

At a glance

Category	Common verbs	Example
Feelings and opinions	like, love, hate, want, prefer, need	I like tea.
Thoughts	know, believe, understand, remember, mean	I don't understand .
Senses and appearance	see, hear, smell, taste, seem, sound	It seems fine.
Possession and being	have, own, belong, be	She owns a shop.

Learning objectives

- Can identify common stative verbs by category (CEFR B1).
- Can avoid the continuous with stative verbs.
- Can handle verbs that are stative in one meaning and active in another.

Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Stative Verbs · CEFR B1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. I ____ this song — turn it up!

- A. 'm loving
- C. loves

- B. love
- D. was loving

2. She ____ the answer.

- A. is knowing
- C. know

- B. knows
- D. was knowing

3. Be quiet, please — we ____ lunch right now.

- A. have
- C. has

- B. are having
- D. were having

4. I ____ a new laptop.

- A. 'm having
- C. has

- B. have
- D. am have

5. This soup ____ delicious.

- A. is tasting
- C. taste

- B. tastes
- D. tasted

6. Ah, I ____ what you mean now.

- A. 'm seeing
- C. sees

- B. see
- D. saw

7. ____ you ____ me?

- A. Are / believing
- C. Are / believe

- B. Do / believe
- D. Do / believing

8. He ____ about changing jobs at the moment.

- A. thinks
- C. think

- B. is thinking
- D. thought

9. Rewrite correctly: 'I am not understanding this exercise.'

- A. I am not understand this exercise.
- C. I not understanding this exercise.

- B. I don't understand this exercise.
- D. I wasn't understanding this exercise.

10. That ____ like a great idea.

- A. is sounding
- C. sound

- B. sounds
- D. sounded

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **B. love** — State verbs like 'love' use the simple: 'I love'.
2. **B. knows** — 'Know' uses the simple: 'she knows'.
3. **B. are having** — 'Have lunch' is an action, so the continuous is fine: 'are having lunch'.
4. **B. have** — 'Have' meaning possession uses the simple: 'I have a new laptop'.
5. **B. tastes** — 'Taste' (a flavour/state) uses the simple: 'tastes delicious'.
6. **B. see** — 'See' = understand uses the simple: 'I see what you mean'.
7. **B. Do / believe** — State verbs form questions with do/does: 'Do you believe me?'.
8. **B. is thinking** — 'Think about' (a mental process) can be continuous: 'is thinking about'.
9. **B. I don't understand this exercise.** — 'Understand' is stative, so use the present simple: 'I don't understand'.
10. **B. sounds** — 'Sound' (an impression) uses the simple: 'sounds like a great idea'.